

are involved is still to be discussed. Even though finding the best tripod requires identifying the optimal combination of trade-offs for your type of photography, the top considerations are usually its sturdiness, weight and ease of use. The stability factor is probably why you bought a tripod in the first place- to keep the camera steady. Though the ultimate way to gauge the sturdiness of a tripod is to try it out, there are various technical specifications that can help you out like the number of tripod leg sections, the material and thickness of leg units, the length of the legs and whether a center column is needed to reach eye level. Tap or apply weight to the top to see if it vibrates or sways, and the best check is to take a few test photos.

The next most important factor is the tripod weight. A fairly straightforward consideration, it can decide how you use the tripod, like whether you can take it along with you on a trek or even on a short stroll around town. Being light weight is thus important for increased usability, but it is more important to make sure that too much sturdiness is not being sacrificed for portability, and vice versa. Further, tripods that do not extend high may weigh a little less but these may also not be as versatile as a result. And finally what's the point of having a tripod if it stays in the closet because you find it too cumbersome to use or end up missing shots as the setting up process is too long? Thus a tripod should be quick and easy to use, which depends majorly on the type of head- pan-tilt or ball headed, and how one positions the leg sections. Either lever/clip locks or twist locks are used in locking mechanisms to extend or contract the tripod's legs and this guides the ease and speed of set up. Lever/clip locks tend to be much quicker to use, although for some types it can be tough to grip when wearing gloves. Twist locks are usually more compact and streamlines but sometimes require both hands if you wish to contract or extend each leg section independently.

Once all important factors have been covered, there are a number of other considerations that will guide how and where you end up using your tripod. Take the number of tripod sections for instance. In general more leg sections reduce stability but also reduce the size of the tripod when fully contracted. It can also mean that it takes longer to position or fully extend the tripod. Similarly to be taken into account is the maximum and minimum height of the tripod. You should make sure that at its maximum extension, the tripod is high enough for you to work comfortably without crouching at your height. To note here is the fact that the tripod's height specification does not include its central column as this can make the